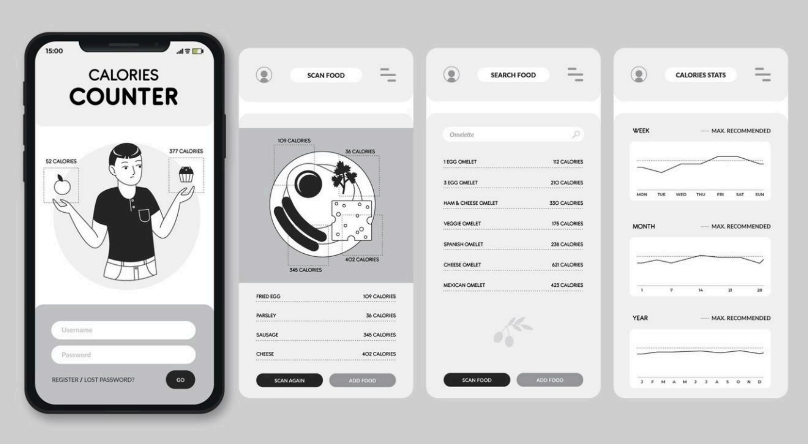
Wireframing & Sketching

Deep Dive into Wireframing & Sketching

- What is a Wireframe?
- Why Wireframing First?
- Types of Wireframes
- Tools for Wireframing
- Wireframe Anatomy – What to Include?
- Sketching Techniques (Fast Planning)
- Common Mistakes to Avoid
- Lo-fi vs Hi-fi Comparison (Visual)

Wireframing & Sketching

Plan before you design: structure over style



FRIED EGG	109 CALORIES
PARSLEY	36 CALORIES
SAUSAGE	345 CALORIES
CHEESE	402 CALORIES

1 EGG OMELET	112 CALORIES
3 EGG OMELET	210 CALORIES
HAM & CHEESE OMELET	330 CALORIES
VEGGIE OMELET	175 CALORIES
SPANISH OMELET	238 CALORIES
CHEESE OMELET	621 CALORIES
MEXICAN OMELET	423 CALORIES

15:00
CALORIES
COUNTER
52 CALORIES
377 CALORIES
Username
Password
REGISTER / LOST PASSWORD?
GO
SCAN FOOD
109 CALORIES
36 CALORIES
345 CALORIES
402 CALORIES
SCAN AGAIN
ADD FOOD
SEARCH FOOD
Omelette
SCAN FOOD
ADD FOOD
CALORIES STATS
WEEK
MAX. RECOMMENDED
MON TUE WED THU FRI SAT SUN
MONTH
MAX. RECOMMENDED
1 7 14 21 28
YEAR
MAX. RECOMMENDED
J F M A M J J A S O N D

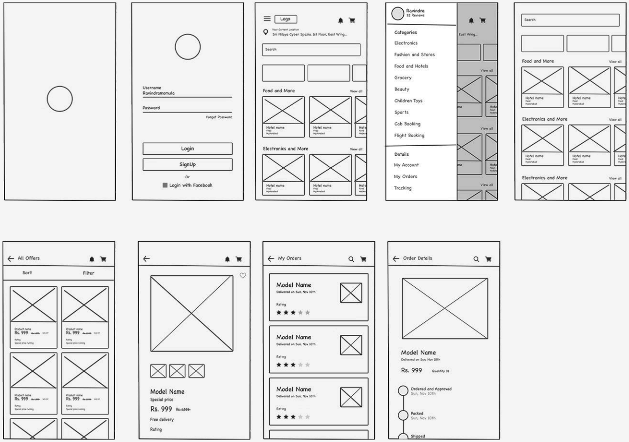
What is a Wireframe?

What is a Wireframe?

A wireframe is a low-fidelity layout of a screen or page.

It shows:

- Structure
- Layout
- Key Elements(not final visuals)


Username
Ravindramomula
Password
Forgot Password
Login
SignUp
Or
Login with Facebook
Logo
Your Current Location
Sri Nilaya Cyber Spazio, 1st Floor, East Wing...
Search
Food and More
View all
Hotel name
Electronics and More
Ravindra
32 Reviews
Categories
Electronics
Fashion and Stores
Food and Hotels
Grocery
Beauty
Children Toys
Sports
Cab Booking
Flight Booking
Details
My Account
My Orders
Tracking
All Offers
Sort
Filter
Product name
Rs. 999
Model Name
Special price
Free delivery
Rating
My Orders
Delivered on Sun, Nov 10th
Order Details
Quantity 01
Ordered and Approved
Sun, Nov 10th
Packed
Shipped

Why Wireframing First?

Why Wireframing First?

- Focuses on functionality before visuals
- Helps test and iterate quickly
- Saves time, fewer changes in final UI
- Aligns team on structure

Types of Wireframes

Types of Wireframes

1. Low-Fidelity (Lo-fi)
2. High-Fidelity (Hi-fi)

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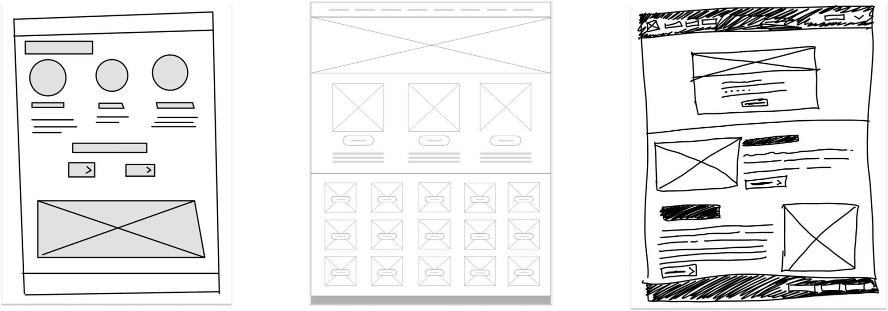
1. Low-Fidelity (Lo-fi)

- Sketches / grayscale boxes
- Fast & rough (paper/Figma shapes)
- Focus on layout



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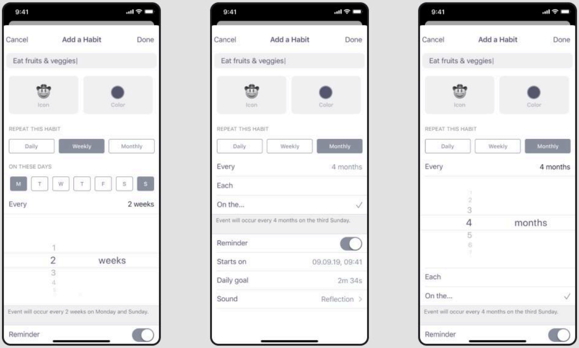
2. High-Fidelity (Hi-fi)

- Includes real content, spacing, and maybe typography
- Still no final colors or images



9:41
Cancel
Add a Habit
Done
Icon
Color
REPEAT THIS HABIT
Daily
Weekly
Monthly
ON THESE DAYS
M
T
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S
1
2
weeks
3
4
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Reminder
9:41
Cancel
Add a Habit
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Icon
Color
REPEAT THIS HABIT
Daily
Weekly
Monthly
Reminder
9:41
Cancel
Add a Habit
Done
Icon
Color
REPEAT THIS HABIT
Daily
Weekly
Monthly
1
2
3
4
months
5
6
7
Reminder

Eat fruits & veggies|

Every 2 weeks

Event will occur every 2 weeks on Monday and Sunday.

Eat fruits & veggies|

Every 4 months

Each

On the... ✓

Event will occur every 4 months on the third Sunday.

Starts on 09.09.19, 09:41

Daily goal 2m 34s

Sound Reflection >

Eat fruits & veggies|

Every 4 months

Each

On the... ✓

Event will occur every 4 months on the third Sunday.

Tools for Wireframing

Tools for Wireframing

Use what works best for your speed and needs:

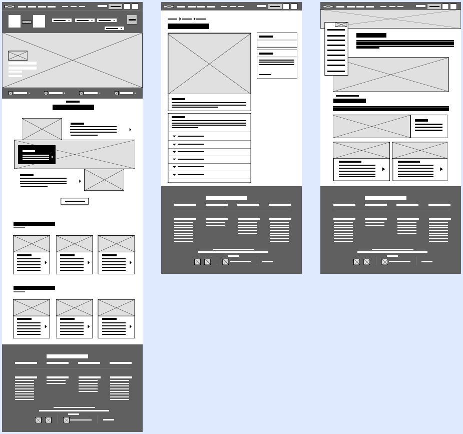
- Pen & paper (fastest)
- Figma / FigJam

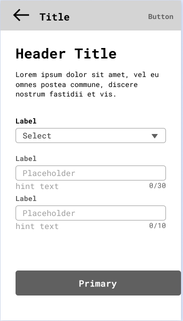
Wireframe Anatomy
What to Include?

Wireframe Anatomy – What to Include?

Each wireframe include:

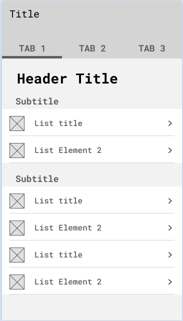
- Navigation (top/bottom)
- Headers/titles
- Buttons
- Input fields
- Images (as gray boxes or icons)
- Content sections




Title
Button
Header Title

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, vel eu omnes postea commune, discere nostrum fastidii et vis.

Label
Select
Label
Placeholder
hint text
0/30
Label
Placeholder
hint text
0/10
Primary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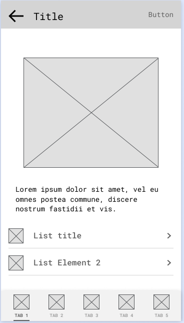
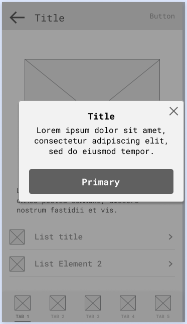
TAB 2
TAB 3
Header Title
Subtitle
List title
List Element 2
Subtitle
List title
List Element 2
List title
List Element 2


Title
Button

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, vel eu omnes postea commune, discere nostrum fastidii et vis.

List title
List Element 2
TAB 1
TAB 2
TAB 3
TAB 4
TAB 5


Title
Button
Title

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor.

Primary
nostrum fastidii et vis.
List title
List Element 2
TAB 1
TAB 2
TAB 3
TAB 4
TAB 5

Sketching Techniques (Fast Planning)

Sketching Techniques (Fast Planning)

You don’t need to be an artist!

Tips:

- Use boxes, lines, circles
- Label everything
- Start with one flow (e.g., login or add task)
- Don’t worry about perfect spacing

Common Mistakes to Avoid

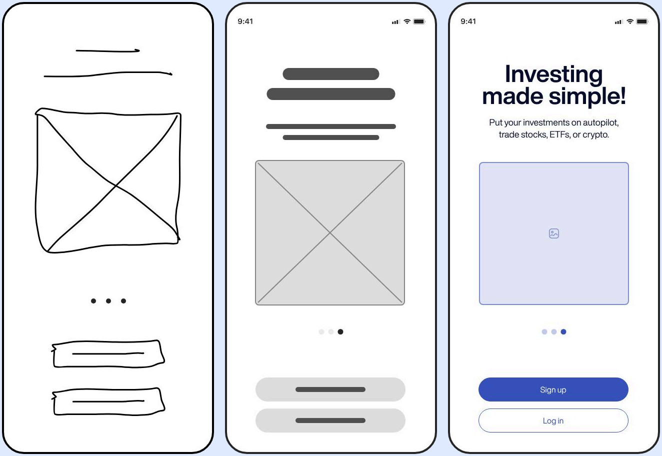
Common Mistakes to Avoid

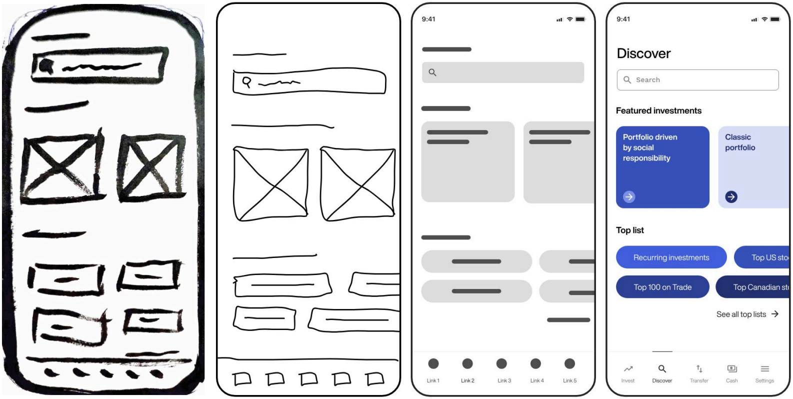
- Over-styling wireframes
- Designing before validating layout
- Adding colors, gradients, shadows too early
- Not using real layout thinking (ignoring space)

Lo-fi vs Hi-fi Comparison (Visual)

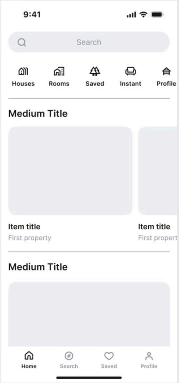
Lo-fi vs Hi-fi Comparison (Visual)

Feature	**Low-Fidelity**	**High-Fidelity**
Speed	Fast	Slower
Detail Level	Basic boxes/labels	More Structure
Use	Early testing, layout	Client/team review

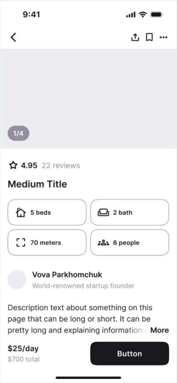

9:41
9:41
Investing made simple!
Put your investments on autopilot, trade stocks, ETFs, or crypto.
Sign up
Log in


9:41
Link 1
Link 2
Link 3
Link 4
Link 5
9:41
Discover
Search
Featured investments
Portfolio driven by social responsibility
Classic portfolio
Top list
Recurring investments
Top US sto
Top 100 on Trade
Top Canadian st
See all top lists
Invest
Discover
Transfer
Cash
Settings

Screen 1


9:41
Search
Houses
Rooms
Saved
Instant
Profile
Medium Title
Item title
First property
Item title
First propert
Medium Title
Home
Search
Saved
Profile

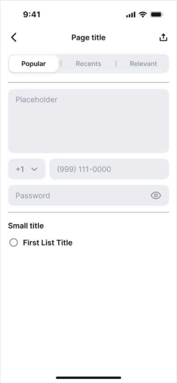
Screen 2

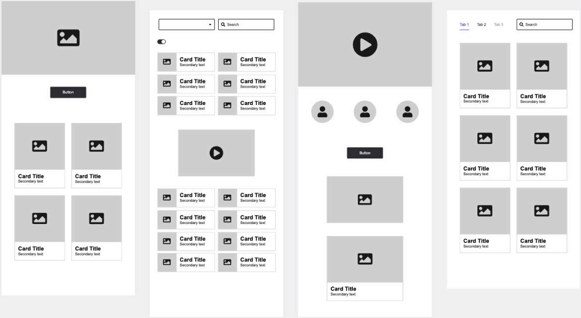

9:41
1/4
4.95
22 reviews
Medium Title
5 beds
2 bath
70 meters
6 people
Vova Parkhomchuk
World-renowned startup founder

Description text about something on this page that can be long or short. It can be pretty long and explaining information … More

$25/day
$700 total
Button

Screen 4


9:41
Page title
Popular
Recents
Relevant
Placeholder
+1
(999) 111-0000
Password
Small title
First List Title


Button
Card Title
Secondary text
Search
Card Title
Secondary text
Button
Card Title
Secondary text
Tab 1
Tab 2
Tab 3
Search
Card Title
Secondary text

Summary

Summary

- Wireframes = design skeletons
- Start lo-fi to explore ideas quickly
- Sketching helps develop ideas fast
- Avoid styling too early
- Prepares you for mockups and user testing

Task

Task

1. Pick an app (e.g., Notes app, Meditation app)
2. Create 3 wireframes:
    - Home Page
    - Listing Page
    - Detail Page
3. Start on paper or directly in Figma
4. Share with classmates for feedback

Try both lo-fi and hi-fi versions